

CRAIG MURRAY, SPHR

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Director of Human Resources | Energy and Industrials | HR, Payroll, and Benefits | AI-Enabled Workforce Analytics

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Human Resources executive with 20+ years of experience leading enterprise-wide HR, payroll, and people operations across energy, industrial, and multinational environments. HR leader with hands-on experience applying artificial intelligence (AI) and advanced analytics to improve workforce decisions, scalability, and operational efficiency. Proven business partner to executive leadership with deep expertise in compensation, benefits, labor and employee relations, talent management, and HR systems. Known for driving operational efficiency, compliance, and organizational change while aligning people strategies with business objectives. Trusted fiduciary with long-standing responsibility for retirement plans, governance, and risk management.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Human Resources Technology | Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence | Generative and Agentic AI | Recruiting | Employee and Labor Relations | Business Process Improvement | Compensation and Benefits | Talent Management | HRIS Implementation | 401(k) Fiduciary Governance | Mergers and Acquisitions Integration | Payroll Management

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Flywheel Energy, LLC — Houston, TX

December 2025 – March 2026

Director, Human Resources

Private exploration and production company based in Oklahoma City, Oklahoma, that acquired the US-based assets of Baytex Energy.

- Served in a short-term integration leadership role following the acquisition of Baytex Energy USA assets; position concluded due to a reduction in force (RIF).

Baytex Energy USA, Inc. — Houston, TX

June 2023 – December 2025

Director, Human Resources

Independent oil and gas company headquartered in Calgary with annual gross revenue of \$2.46B; acquired Ranger Oil Corporation in 2023 and was later acquired by Flywheel Energy, LLC. Senior US Human Resources representative reporting to the Vice President, Chief Legal Officer, and Corporate Secretary based in Calgary.

- Developed a machine learning-based compensation offer system using annual review and compensation survey data to evaluate new hire offers and ensure internal and external pay alignment.
- Implemented a Microsoft Teams and Microsoft Excel-based system to conduct annual compensation reviews, reducing errors and improving efficiency.
- Served as named fiduciary and administrative representative for the company 401(k) plan.
- Conducted a 401(k) request for proposal (RFP) resulting in a provider change that reduced 401(k)-related fees by 45%.
- Aligned corporate payroll systems across borders through the implementation of ADP.
- Implemented performance management and first-line supervisor training, using ChatGPT to customize training content for various organizational audiences.

Ranger Oil Corporation — Houston, TX

October 2021 – June 2023

Director, Human Resources

Independent oil and gas company formed through the merger of Penn Virginia Corporation and Lonestar Resources US, Inc., with annual gross revenue of \$552.7M; acquired by Baytex Energy USA, Inc. Senior Human Resources representative reporting to the Vice President, Chief Legal Officer, and Corporate Secretary.

- Led the Human Resources and Facilities team through the merger with Lonestar Resources, integrating employees and related systems.
- Served as named fiduciary and administrative representative for the company 401(k) plan.
- Led an organizational review of locally available office space and the renewal of the current lease.

Penn Virginia Corporation — Houston, TX

June 2013 – October 2021

Director, Human Resources (2016 – 2021); Manager, Human Resources (2013 – 2016)

Independent oil and gas company engaged in the exploration, development, and production of oil, NGLs, and natural gas in the Eagle Ford Shale, with annual gross revenue of \$273.3M; acquired by Ranger Oil Corporation. Senior Human Resources

professional reporting to the Vice President, Chief Legal Counsel, and Corporate Secretary, responsible for payroll and all domestic Human Resources programs and systems.

- Served as named fiduciary and administrative representative for the company 401(k) plan.
- Implemented a new payroll and HRIS platform, reducing payroll processing fees by 50% while increasing functionality.
- Improved recruiting, screening, and onboarding processes, reducing employment costs and improving quality of hire and candidate experience.
- Organized a review of historical documents, purging unrequired records, inventorying documents to be retained, and initiating the use of electronic documents through Adobe Sign.
- Implemented electronic document workflows to streamline Human Resources processes.
- Implemented a leadership development program focused on senior and mid-level managers.

RPC, Inc. — The Woodlands, TX

January 2011 – June 2013

Director, Recruiting and Retention

Provider of oilfield services and equipment to independent and major oilfield companies in the exploration, production, and development of oil and gas properties, domestically and in select international markets. Primary service lines include fracturing, snubbing, coiled tubing, and wireline. Responsible for developing and implementing standardized staffing and employment practices across an entrepreneurial, geographically diverse organization, with three direct reports.

- Implemented a recruiting and onboarding platform, reducing cost per hire and time to fill.
- Led high-volume recruiting operations supporting the hiring of more than 900 employees per year.
- Developed a college recruiting program focused on entry-level field engineers, attending events at 14 colleges.
- Implemented an employment metrics program to define current and historical workforce trends.
- Reduced turnover by 30% in two years through improved hiring practices and employee relations.

Energy Maintenance Services, LLC — Houston, TX

2010 – 2011

Operations Manager

Calpine Corporation — Houston, TX

2000 – 2009

Director, Human Resources (2006 – 2009); Manager, Human Resources (2000 – 2006)

CalEnergy Operating Corporation (currently Coso Operating Company, LLC)

1990 – 2000

Training and Employment Manager — Calipatria, CA (1999 – 2000)

Operations and HR Manager — Dieng, Central Java, Indonesia (1997 – 1999)

Training and HR Manager — Leyte, Philippines (1995 – 1997)

Training Supervisor — Ridgecrest, CA (1992 – 1995)

Control Room Operator, Geothermal — Ridgecrest, CA (1990 – 1992)

MILITARY EXPERIENCE

United States Navy — Japan and Philippines

1979 – 1990

Machinist Mate, Steam Propulsion and Auxiliary Systems

HR TECHNOLOGY AND AI SKILLS

HRIS: ADP, UKG, Paycor, Kudos, HR Performance Pro

Analytics: Python, NumPy, Pandas, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, PyTorch

AI Enablement: LM Studio, Ollama, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), n8n, LangChain, SHAP

Models: Linear and Logistic Regression, Support Vector Machines, XGBoost, Gradient Boosted Trees, Neural Networks, Natural Language Processing (NLP)

EDUCATION

Post Graduate Program, Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning — The University of Texas at Austin, December 2025

Post Graduate Program, Data Science and Business Analytics — The University of Texas at Austin, May 2025

Master of Business Administration (MBA) — Bellevue University, June 1999

Graduate Certificate, Human Resource Management — Chapman University, November 1993

Bachelor of Science, Vocational Education Studies — Southern Illinois University, August 1989

CERTIFICATIONS

Senior Professional in Human Resources (SPHR) — HR Certification Institute (HRCI), since 2000